Disadvantages

The client must know all the policy classes and decide which one to use. This means that the client must understand the differences between these algorithms in order to select the appropriate algorithm class in time. In other words, the policy pattern only applies to all the algorithms or behaviors that the client knows.

Policy patterns create many policy classes, and each specific policy class generates a new class. Sometimes, policy classes can be designed to be shared by storing environment-dependent states in the client, so that policy class instances can be used by different clients. In other words, you can use the hedgehog pattern to reduce the number of objects.